PUBLIC COMMENT FOR THE RECORD
Date: September 16, 2026
Subject: Protecting Municipal Autonomy and Privacy Against the Expansion of Warrantless Surveillance Software
Submitted By: Augustus Chell (Williamsburg)
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Good morning, Commissioners.

My name is Augustus Chell. I am 21 years old and a proud resident of Williamsburg. I work a real, working-class job right down the road at the Traverse City Gordon Food Service. I am standing here today because I love my Nation, my State, and my Home. This love dictates my firm belief that every single individual is equal, and valued the same under the law.

Right now, our nation's sacred promise of liberty, justice, and human dignity for all is facing an unprecedented assault from an unregulated AI surveillance grid. As it stands, this board holds the direct budgetary oversight that sustains its operational foundation.

Flock has explicitly misrepresented core facts in its own public-facing privacy materials. Their official statements claim that "no one from Flock can view this footage." Yet, recent federal class-action lawsuits (Schulte v. Flock Group Inc.) and internal department audits have exposed this as a flat-out falsehood. Company logs proved that Flock vice presidents and employees routinely access private camera feeds—including sensitive settings like community centers, playgrounds, and daycare facilities—for internal sales demos without the knowledge or permission of those being filmed.

This is a company built on extreme corporate overreach and intentional deception. Flock built and deployed physical hardware modules inside their cameras that were not yet locally authorized or legally permitted for use by the purchasing municipalities. They intentionally designed their physical infrastructure so that silent, sweeping expansions of general surveillance capabilities required nothing more than a remote, backend software update. This means the physical capability for broader, unconstitutional spying is already mounted on our utility poles, completely bypassing public debate, legislative approval, and therefore the will of the people.

The deeper we look into this out-of-state corporation, the cloudier and more deceptive their operations become. In a widely verified July 2026 investigative report by independent journalist TommyG, attempting to secure a basic interview or corporate meeting with Flock Safety was met with systemic stonewalling and evasion. The company treats its physical operations like a state secret, keeping its corporate headquarters hidden off standard navigation platforms like Google Maps. When independent journalist TommyG finally navigated corporate gatekeepers to secure a scheduled meeting, company executives completely evaded the press by abruptly relocating their multi-floor headquarters to the Medici building in Buckhead at the end of June 2026. This sudden move allowed them to hide behind a secure facility that bore no visible external corporate branding or public signage.

The City of Traverse City and the Downtown Development Authority listened to the public and explicitly rejected a contract for downtown Flock cameras. Yet, the Grand Traverse County Sheriff's Office bypassed that democratic choice. They exploited the lines of local jurisdiction by maneuvering through individual township boards like Garfield, East Bay, and Peninsula to quietly secure side-deals to ring the city borders with an automated surveillance wall. This creates a functional trap—forcing Traverse City residents and local commuters to be systematically tracked by the very same network they already democratically rejected inside city limits.

You fund and oversee the Sheriff's Office that operates 28 warrantless cameras across our surrounding townships. Everyday, my movements are catalogued arriving to and leaving work due to the camera tracking intersections right outside my workplace at South Airport and Barlow. Collectively, this local grid captures nearly 450,000 vehicle fingerprints every single month right here in our county. That is not targeted law enforcement; that is the mass dragnet tracking of innocent American citizens driving to work, taking their kids to school, and simply buying groceries. This system completely subverts the sacred presumption of innocence by treating every single driver in this nation like a permanent criminal suspect until proven otherwise.

The company also actively weaponizes local emergency services to silence public oversight. As documented in a September 2026 InvestigateTV report, when journalists, auditors, and everyday citizens attempt to photograph or document these camera systems operating in plain view on public roads,

corporate employees repeatedly call 911. This corporate aggression was explicitly demonstrated on August 19, 2026, in Milton, Georgia, when a technician called emergency services on an investigative reporter filming a public camera upgrade, and similarly on June 5, 2026, in Smyrna, Georgia, when management summoned police to remove citizens filming outside a facility. In shocking displays of corporate-directed overreach, responding police officers have physically blocked entire public roadways with patrol cars, trapping innocent citizen vehicles on the street purely because a private contractor's workers objected to being observed. This constitutes a severe violation of our First Amendment rights, due process, a total suspension of the right to travel freely on public roads, and a dangerous misuse of local taxpayer-funded law enforcement resources to act as private corporate security guards.

We must address the dark fiscal paradox at play here. When local governments appropriate public funds for these surveillance dragnets, they are not using corporate money—they are using the hard-earned tax dollars of the working class. Every dollar funneled into these software portals represents a mandatory contribution stolen from the citizens themselves. Taxpayers are being forced to financially underwrite the very infrastructure that destroys their own constitutional rights, effectively paying a corporate entity to strip them of their privacy, track their daily labor routes, and expose them to false arrests.

Independent legal watchdogs have just launched a national database documenting over 100 severe cases of rogue officers abusing license plate grids to stalk women, mistresses, and romantic rivals. We are seeing this reality play out right now in Milwaukee, Wisconsin and McHenry County, Illinois, where officers used the system to stalk ex-girlfriends, and in Florida where a sheriff used the police network and tracking cameras to stalk an actress after she rejected his advances.

Worse yet, public records and civil liberties investigations have revealed that this technology is notoriously prone to severe algorithmic error. In major metropolitan audits, up to 70% of automated stolen vehicle alerts generated by these camera grids were flagged as completely false positives. These are not harmless computer glitches; they have directly resulted in innocent motorists being subjected to high-risk felony traffic stops, where everyday citizens are forced out of their vehicles at gunpoint by police officers acting on faulty,

unverified corporate data.

Flock is not an isolated law enforcement tool; it is a foundational stepping stone to upend our Constitution by feeding data into a broader digital tracking matrix. This localized tracking grid directly mirrors macro-financial surveillance models currently being engineered globally under Project Agorá. Orchestrated by the Bank for International Settlements (BIS) alongside seven major global central banks—including the Federal Reserve Bank of New York—this initiative consolidates private financial transactions onto a single, unified programmable ledger. The ultimate goal is to facilitate real-time automated tracking and implement smart-contract programmable restrictions over private deposits.

A critical danger arises when this centralized financial ledger converges with federal automotive infrastructure, specifically the government-mandated vehicle kill-switch framework enacted under Section 24220 of the Infrastructure Investment and Jobs Act (Public Law 117–58). This federal law directs the Department of Transportation and the National Highway Traffic Safety Administration (NHTSA) to establish safety standards forcing advanced impaired driving prevention technology into all new passenger vehicles. These passive surveillance systems are designed to constantly monitor driver performance, giving the system the algorithmic authority to limit or entirely prevent vehicle operation. When a centralized authority controls your ability to pass through an automated camera wall, overrides your engine via federal mandate, and monitors your transaction ledger, individual liberty ceases to exist.

Communities across our state are waking up to this liability. Prominent municipal boards right here in Michigan—including Rochester, Ferndale, Clawson, and Milford Township—have all formally voted to terminate, scale back, or reject their surveillance camera contracts over severe privacy and oversight concerns. Even the people of Traverse City recognized that a system without transparent boundaries is an inherent threat to the public trust and voted to keep Flock out. The Sheriff's Office surveillance wall around the city borders is proof of that threat.

Because it was individual townships that signed these hardware contracts, you may feel your hands are tied. However, looking closely at the fiscal reality: the Sheriff's Office cannot operate this network without county resources. You hold

the absolute power of the purse over the county personnel and software infrastructure required to make this network function.

Therefore, I urge this Board to stand up for liberty and the privacy of our taxpayers. Please carefully consider three direct budgetary actions detailed in this submission:

• First, defund the integration software: Vote to prohibit any county taxpayer funds from being used to purchase, renew, or maintain backend server connections or database licenses tied to automated license plate reader vendors.

• Second, institute a strict zero-county-labor policy: Attach a legally binding rider to the Sheriff's budget mandating that zero county-funded employee hours be spent reviewing mass-dragnet alerts or data logs unless a human investigator first presents a signed warrant from a judge.

• Third, mandate independent search audits: Enforce a strict tech-oversight policy requiring an independent, third-party audit of every single query conducted in the database to prevent rogue stalking and systemic tracking abuses.

By cutting off the county-funded labor and infrastructure, you break the network effect that Flock relies on. You render their regional dragnet blind, protect the Fourth Amendment, and restore the presumption of innocence for every single worker and family commuting through this county.

You have the absolute power to stop this tracking network right here in our county. Pull the plug on Flock Safety, stand up for liberty, and defund the Sheriff's use of this grid.

Thank you.

APPENDIX: SPOKEN TRANSCRIPT

Good morning, Commissioners.

My name is Augustus Chell. I am 21 years old and a proud resident of Williamsburg. I work a real, working-class job right down the road at the Traverse City Gordon Food Service. I am standing here today because I love my Nation, my State, and my Home. This love dictates my firm belief that every single individual is equal, and valued the same under the law.

Right now, our nation's sacred promise of liberty, justice, and human dignity for all is facing an unprecedented assault from an unregulated AI surveillance grid. As it stands, this board holds the direct budgetary oversight that sustains its operational foundation here in Grand Traverse County.

The City of Traverse City explicitly rejected a contract for Flock cameras. Yet, the Sheriff's Office bypassed that democratic choice. They quietly secured side-deals through individual township boards—like Garfield, East Bay, and Peninsula—to ring the city borders with an automated surveillance wall. This creates a functional trap, forcing local commuters to be systematically tracked by a network they already democratically rejected inside city lines.

Every single day, my movements are catalogued arriving to and leaving work due to the surveillance camera tracking intersections right outside my workplace at South Airport and Barlow. Collectively, this local grid captures nearly 450,000 vehicle fingerprints every single month right here in our county. That is not targeted law enforcement; that is the mass dragnet tracking of innocent American citizens driving to work, taking kids to school, and buying groceries. This system completely subverts the sacred presumption of innocence by treating every local driver like a permanent criminal suspect until proven otherwise.

Over a million heroes have died for our liberty, and millions more have given everything they had and sacrificed for our pursuit of happiness. It is our absolute civic duty to stand up for what is right, to protect our nation, and to live and die free. Flock is just another stepping stone to upend our Constitution. When local governments appropriate public funds for these surveillance dragnets, taxpayers are forced to financially underwrite the very tools that

destroy their own constitutional rights.

Now, you may feel your hands are tied because individual townships signed these hardware contracts. But let’s look closely at the fiscal reality: the Sheriff's Office cannot operate this network without county resources. You hold the absolute power of the purse over the county personnel and software infrastructure required to make this network function.

I urge this Board to stand up for liberty and protect the privacy of our taxpayers. Please consider the three direct budgetary actions detailed before the appendix of my written statement: defund the backend integration software, institute a strict zero-county-labor policy for warrantless tracking, and mandate independent search audits.

Pull the plug on Flock Safety, stand up for liberty, and defund the Sheriff's use of this grid.

Thank you.